

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1252

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to recognize Trooper William Bennett on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal concerns to ensure the public safety and welfare, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant individuals; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Trooper William Bennett of the Tennessee Highway Patrol, who has rendered sterling service to the people of the State of Tennessee for thirty years and will be taking his much-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, a 1986 graduate of Mt. Juliet High School, Trooper Bennett is a United States Army veteran who served with the 82nd Airborne Division at Fort Bragg during the mid-1980s; and

WHEREAS, following his honorable discharge from active duty, he worked as a commercial diver in the offshore oilfield industry while continuing his military service with the Tennessee and Texas National Guard; and

WHEREAS, Trooper Bennett attended Middle Tennessee State University, where he earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Criminal Justice with minors in Psychology and Political Science; and

WHEREAS, Trooper William Bennett began his law enforcement career in 1997 with the Wilson County Sheriff's Department as a patrol officer and was selected in 2002 to attend the Tennessee Highway Patrol Academy; upon graduation from the Academy, he served as a road trooper in Sumner and Wilson counties before transferring to the Capitol Protection Unit in Davidson County; and

WHEREAS, Trooper Bennett, working with the Tennessee Highway Patrol, has been indispensable in the fight for a safe and just society; during his tenure, he has received

numerous accolades for his dedicated service while becoming a friend to many members of the Tennessee General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, on multiple occasions, he has run into harm's way to protect members and staff of the Cordell Hull Building, including one notable instance in which he assisted in disarming an individual who had pulled a firearm; and

WHEREAS, outside of protecting and serving his fellow citizens, Trooper William Bennett commits his time to his family life with his beloved wife and two children, Wyatt and Abigail, who are his greatest highlights, at their home in Lebanon; in addition, he has proudly owned and maintained his father's Tennessee Orange 1979 CJ5 Jeep; and

WHEREAS, Trooper Bennett epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean, and his professionalism and dedication to serving his community are evident to all who know him; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to recognize and applaud Trooper William Bennett for his dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Trooper William Bennett on the occasion of his retirement, thank him for his meritorious service, and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.